

want to change this default level to suit the needs of your project. This article walks you through the process of changing the default level in UE5.

1. Create or Select the New Default Level

First, ensure that the level you wish to set as the default exists in your project. If it doesn't, you'll need to create it. To create a new level, navigate to 'File' > 'New Level'.

2. Save the New Default Level

Before you can set your level as the default, you need to save it. Navigate to 'File' > 'Save Current' and choose a location within your project's Content folder. Ensure you give it an identifiable name.

3. Navigate to Project Settings

To change the default level, you'll need to access the Project Settings. You can do this by navigating to 'Edit' > 'Project Settings' in the main menu.

4. Changing the Default Maps

Within Project Settings, scroll down to the Maps & Modes section. Here, you will find options to set the 'Editor Startup Map' and the 'Game Default Map'.

The 'Editor Startup Map' is the level that loads automatically when you open your project in the UE5 Editor.

The 'Game Default Map' is the level that loads when you play your game outside the UE5 Editor, such as when you package your game for distribution.

Click on the dropdown menu next to each option and select the level you wish to set as the default.

5. Save Your Changes

After you've selected your new default level(s), make sure to save your changes. You can do this by clicking the 'File' > 'Save All' in the main menu.

And that's it! You have successfully changed the default level in your UE5 project. Please note that you can change these settings at any time, so feel free to experiment and see what works best for your specific needs.

Remember, managing your levels effectively is a crucial aspect of game development. By setting the right default level, you can streamline your workflow and make your project more organized and efficient.

Audio design and development using level design

Sound design is a pivotal aspect of game development that contributes to the overall immersive experience. In Unreal Engine 5 (UE5), sound design is intertwined with level design, enhancing the player's sensory perception within the game world. Here's how you can make the most of audio design in your UE5 levels.

1. Importing Audio Assets

Before you can begin, you'll need some audio files to work with. UE5 supports various audio file formats, including .wav, .ogg, and .flac. Import your audio files by dragging and dropping them into the Content Browser. After importing, these will appear as Sound Wave assets.

2. Creating Sound Cues

While a Sound Wave asset represents a single sound file, a Sound Cue can contain multiple Sound Waves and implement more complex behavior. Right-click on an imported Sound Wave and select 'Create Cue'. You can then open the Sound Cue Editor and add more sounds or adjust how the sound will be played, such as randomizing pitch or volume, looping, or mixing multiple sounds together.

3. Placing Sounds in the Level

To add sounds to your level, simply drag and drop the Sound Cue from the Content Browser into the Level Editor. This will create an Ambient Sound actor, which you can move and adjust like any other actor. These sounds will play whenever the player is close enough to hear them.

4. Attenuation and Spatialization

Sound attenuation and spatialization are key elements of audio design in UE5. These settings control how sounds behave based on the player's distance and direction from the sound source.

To enable attenuation, open your Sound Cue in the Sound Cue Editor, select the Sound Node, and check the 'Override Attenuation' box in the Details panel. You can then adjust the attenuation settings, including the shape and size of the sound's area of influence, and how the sound's volume decreases with distance.

5. Using Audio Volumes

Audio Volumes allow you to control the audio settings within specific areas of your level. This can be used to create areas with different echo effects, to gradually change the background music, or to control the overall volume of sound effects. Create an Audio Volume in the Level Editor by selecting 'Volumes' from the Place Actors panel and choosing 'Audio Volume'.

6. Implementing Sound Effects

UE5 also supports the creation of sound effects like footsteps, item pick-ups, or UI clicks. To implement these, you will typically tie the playing of a Sound Cue to a specific event in your game's Blueprint scripts.

By taking advantage of these tools, you can create an immersive audio experience in your UE5 levels. Remember, good sound design can significantly enhance your game's atmosphere and player immersion, so don't underestimate its impact. **d**